

30/07/2025

At Variance with, Unless, Ascertain, Angst, Thwart

1. At Variance with (के विपरीत) (*Phrase*) (æt 'vɛəriəns wið) (*Formal tone*)

- **Meaning (English):** In disagreement or not in harmony with something or someone.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** किसी से असहमति में या विरोध में होना।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Latin *variantia* (difference) → **Old French *variance*** → Middle English "variance"
→ **Phrase formation in legal/academic contexts.**
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonyms:** in conflict with, contrary to, in opposition
 - **Antonyms:** in agreement with, aligned with
- **Connotation:** Neutral-formal; often used in academic/legal contexts
- **Pictorial Scenario:** A legal document showing two departments disagreeing on a policy.



- **Use in Non-Fiction (100 words):**

Academic research is often **at variance with** popular opinion, as it prioritizes evidence over belief. For instance, while mainstream media may portray certain diets as beneficial, scientific studies may be at variance with such claims due to lack of

reproducible evidence. In law, a testimony at variance with prior statements may weaken a case, demonstrating how critical consistency is in formal investigations. The phrase serves as a powerful tool to diplomatically highlight conflicts or contradictions.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage:**

- ✓ *His views are at variance with the official report.* (उसके विचार आधिकारिक रिपोर्ट से विपरीत हैं।)
- ✗ *His views at variance the official report.* (Incorrect preposition and structure)

- **Word Hack of the Day:**

- When you're unsure about a contradiction in opinions or data, use "at variance with" instead of saying "against" — it sounds more formal and scholarly.

- **Example + Grammar Breakdown:**

- *Her beliefs are at variance with the company's policies.* (उसकी मान्यताएँ कंपनी की नीतियों से मेल नहीं खातीं।)
- **Grammar Breakdown:**
 - S (Subject): Her beliefs
 - V (Verb – Linking): are
 - C (Complement – Prepositional Phrase): at variance with the company's policies
 - ↳ Object of Preposition: the company's policies
 - ↳ Prepositional Phrase within complement: with the company's policies

- **Common Collocations:**

- at variance with the law, at variance with principles, at variance with testimony

- **My Statement:**

- The student was at variance with the professor's opinion and proposed an alternative.
- Some employees expressed views that were at variance with company policies.
- Many bank employees were at variance with the proposal to work six days a week.

- **My Notes:** [Leave as Placeholder]

2. Unless (जब तक नहीं / यदि नहीं) (*Conjunction*) (ʌn'les) (*Neutral tone*)

- **Meaning (English):** Except if a certain condition is met.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** जब तक ऐसा न हो, या यदि ऐसा न हो।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Middle English *onlesse* = *on* (not) + *lesse* (less)
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonyms:** except if, only if not
 - **Antonyms:** provided that, as long as
- **Connotation:** Neutral – Conditional or restrictive tone
- **Pictorial Scenario:** A signboard saying "No entry **unless** authorized."



- **Use in Non-Fiction (100 words):**

Unless is a powerful conjunction used to set boundaries or conditions. In legal documents, "unless otherwise stated" is a standard clause to define exceptions. In personal development literature, phrases like "You cannot grow unless you challenge yourself" stress the importance of conditions for progress. Policy frameworks use "unless" to specify scenarios that are excluded from general rules. Its use in programming and decision-making also emphasizes logic-based outcomes.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage:**

- ✓ *You won't succeed unless you try.* (जब तक आप प्रयास नहीं करेंगे, तब तक आप सफल नहीं होंगे।)
- ✗ *Unless you won't try, you won't succeed.* (Double negative misuse)

- **Word Hack of the Day:**

- To express exceptions or non-negotiable rules, insert "unless" for logical clarity and to avoid verbose conditionals.

- **Example + Grammar Breakdown:**

- *I won't go unless it's necessary.* (मैं नहीं जाऊँगा जब तक कि यह ज़रूरी न हो।)

- **Grammar Breakdown:**

- S (Subject): I
- V (Verb – Auxiliary + Base): won't go (will not go)
- O (Object): — (None; intransitive verb)
- + (Adverbial Clause of Condition): unless it's necessary
 - ↳ S: it
 - ↳ V (Linking Verb): is (contracted as "s")
 - ↳ C (Complement – Adjective): necessary

- **Common Collocations:**

- unless stated otherwise, unless and until, unless proven

- **My Statement:**

- Nobody will be treated as a criminal until proven guilty.
- Don't do anything on your own unless instructed otherwise.
- You shouldn't purchase anything unless you genuinely need it.

- **My Notes:** [Leave as Placeholder]

3. Ascertain (पता लगाना) (Verb) (, æsər'tein) (Formal tone)

- **Meaning (English):** To find out or make certain through investigation or testing.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** किसी तथ्य की सच्चाई का पता लगाना।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Latin *certus* (certain) → **Old French** *acertener* → Middle English *ascertain*
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonyms:** determine, verify, confirm
 - **Antonyms:** ignore, guess, overlook
- **Connotation:** Formal, investigative
- **Pictorial Scenario:** A detective using a magnifying glass to **ascertain** the truth.



- **Use in Non-Fiction (100 words):**

Scientific studies aim to **ascertain** the relationship between variables through controlled experimentation. Journalists are trained to ascertain facts before publishing, highlighting the word's association with verification and truth. In law, to ascertain liability means determining fault through evidence. The term is commonly used in corporate risk assessments, audits, and financial forecasts to validate assumptions. It emphasizes due diligence and objective accuracy.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage:**

- ✓ *We must ascertain the cause of the problem.* (हमें समस्या का कारण पता लगाना चाहिए।)
- ✗ *We must ascertain about the problem.* (No "about" needed with this verb)

- **Word Hack of the Day:**

- Use "ascertain" in place of "find out" in formal writing to sound more credible and objective.

- **Example + Grammar Breakdown:**

- *They tried to ascertain the truth behind the rumors.* (उन्होंने अफवाहों के पीछे की सच्चाई का पता लगाने की कोशिश की।)
- **Grammar Breakdown:**
 - S (Subject): They
 - V (Verb – Main Verb + Infinitive): tried to ascertain
 - O (Object): the truth
 - + (Prepositional Phrase – Modifying “truth”): behind the rumors
 - ↳ P (Preposition): behind
 - ↳ O (Object of the Preposition): the rumors

- **Common Collocations:**

- ascertain the cause, ascertain the facts, ascertain with certainty

- **My Statement:**

- The officers tried to ascertain the facts in the real-time investigation.
- They are trained to ascertain the facts with absolute certainty in every situation.
- We are trying to ascertain the cause of the virus’s spread and are close to identifying it.

- **My Notes:**

- "Ascertain" is a transitive verb, so it must have a direct object.

4. Angst (चिंता / बेचैनी) (Noun) (æŋst) (Emotional tone)

- **Meaning (English):** A deep, often unfocused anxiety or dread, especially about life or the future.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** गहरी चिंता या बेचैनी, विशेष रूप से भविष्य को लेकर।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - German *Angst* (fear, dread) → **Adopted into English via existential literature**
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonyms:** anxiety, worry, dread
 - **Antonyms:** calm, confidence, peace
- **Connotation:** Emotional/negative
- **Pictorial Scenario:** A student nervously pacing the floor before result day.



- **Use in Non-Fiction (100 words):**

Existential **angst** is a central theme in many philosophical and psychological discussions. From adolescent uncertainty to mid-life crisis, angst captures emotional discomfort tied to identity, purpose, or societal pressure. In marketing, brands sometimes play on consumer angst to promote solutions. The word has gained popularity in self-help contexts, where recognizing and managing angst is part of emotional intelligence.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage:**

- ✓ *He felt a wave of angst before the interview.* (उसने इंटरव्यू से पहले चिंता की लहर महसूस की।)
- ✗ *He angsts before interview.* ("Angst" is a noun, not verb in English)

- **Word Hack of the Day:**

- Use "angst" when "worry" feels too shallow—especially when referring to deeper personal dilemmas or identity crises.

- **Example + Grammar Breakdown:**

- *Teenage angst often reflects deeper identity conflicts.* (किशोरावस्था की बेचैनी अक्सर गहरे पहचान संबंधी संघर्षों को दर्शाती है।)
- **Grammar Breakdown:**
 - S (Subject): Teenage angst
 - V (Verb – Transitive): reflects
 - O (Object): deeper identity conflicts
 - + (Adverb – Frequency): often

- **Common Collocations:**

- teenage angst, existential angst, silent angst

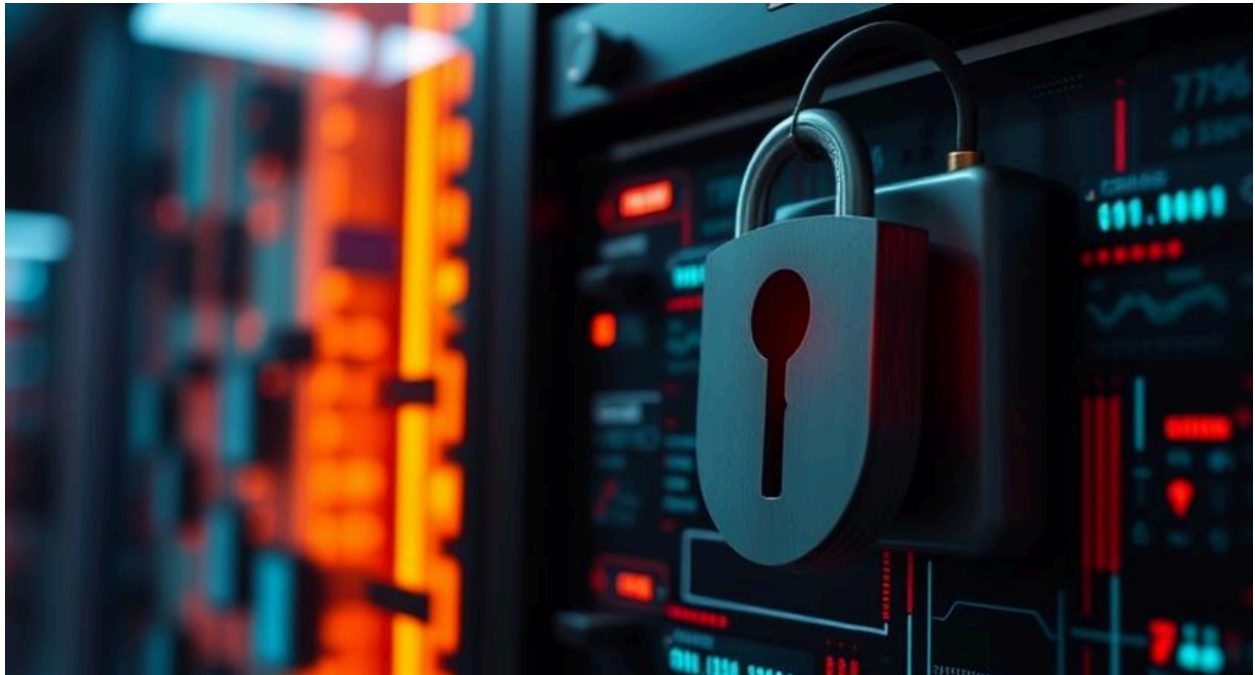
- **My Statement:**

- He was suffering from a silent angst, and he couldn't do anything about it.
- He was filled with angst after taking an exam that could decide his future.
- His existential angst was evident to everyone except himself.

- **My Notes:** [Leave as Placeholder]

5. Thwart (विफल करना) (Verb) (θwɔ:rt) (Decisive tone)

- **Meaning (English):** To prevent someone from achieving something; to oppose successfully.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** किसी योजना या उद्देश्य को विफल करना।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Old Norse *thverr* (transverse) → **Middle English *thwert* (to oppose)** → Modern English
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonyms:** obstruct, hinder, foil
 - **Antonyms:** assist, enable, facilitate
- **Connotation:** Assertive/Strategic
- **Pictorial Scenario:** A security system thwarting a cyber attack.



- **Use in Non-Fiction (100 words):**

In cybersecurity, firewalls are designed to **thwart** malicious intrusions. In politics, opposition parties attempt to thwart controversial bills. Even in self-development, one might thwart harmful habits by building stronger routines. The term often implies deliberate obstruction, making it a useful word for both strategic interventions and narrative setbacks.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage:**

- ✓ *The security team thwarted the hacking attempt.* (सुरक्षा टीम ने हैकिंग की कोशिश को विफल कर दिया।)
- ✗ *He thwart to go there.* (Incorrect structure; "thwart" needs an object)

- **Word Hack of the Day:**

- Use "thwart" to express strong, intentional prevention or blocking, especially in formal or technical writing.

- **Example + Grammar Breakdown:**

- *She thwarted his plans by arriving early.* (उसने जल्दी आकर उसकी योजनाओं को विफल कर दिया।)
- **Grammar Breakdown:**
 - S (Subject): She
 - V (Verb – Transitive): thwarted
 - O (Object): his plans
 - + (Adverbial Phrase of Manner/Means): by arriving early
 - ↳ V (Non-finite Verb – Gerund): arriving
 - ↳ Adv (Adverb – Time): early

- **Common Collocations:**

- thwart a plan, thwart an attempt, thwart progress

- **My Statement:**

- He was finally able to thwart any possible deviations and stick to his routine with consistency.
- The team's solution thwarted an attempt to breach user data.
- The bad weather thwarted the show's progress, ultimately resulting in its immediate closure.

- **My Notes:** [Leave as Placeholder]